Player characters in the Hollow World of Hykaen ought to be unique and individual, an inseparable, holistic, whole, but for the purposes of character creation I find it expedient to divide them into two main parts. First, there is the mechanical (affectionately known as “crunch”), which is where the character interacts with the rules of the game. This includes their Attributes, Skills, Equipment, Spells, and Talents. Second, there is the storytelling side (affectionately known as “fluff” or “flavor”), which is where the character interacts with the world, the other characters, and with the story the players and GM tell. This includes background information, personality traits, relationships with other characters, ambitions, fears, and so forth.

Both the mechanical and flavorful sides are essential to a satisfying experience playing the game, and as such, we will be covering both in this chapter.

The Mechanics

The Seven Attributes

The bulk of a character’s capabilities are derived from their Attribute scores. These represent the fundamental mental, physical, and social qualities of a character. The seven attributes are as follows:

Strength: Strength represents physical power and athleticism. It contributes to your character’s melee weapon combat, carrying capacity, and ability to run, lift, shove, and jump.

Constitution: Constitution is your physical health and raw toughness. It affects your character’s hit points, stamina, Fortitude defense, and ability to resist extreme heat or cold, diseases, poisons, and similar. Some classes, like Warlocks and Battleminds, have abilities that let them channel magic or psionics directly through their bodies, and Constitution determines how effectively they can do so.

Dexterity: Dexterity is quickness, agility, and precision. It determines your ranged weapon combat, Reflex defense, initiative, and a number of skills like Mobility, Thievery/Sleight of Hand, and Stealth. Certain precision weapons, like daggers, can be used in melee combat using Dexterity instead of Strength.

Willpower: Willpower is strength of will, mastery of self, and force of personality. It determines your Will defense, contributes to stamina, and allows your character to shrug off many abilities that affect the mind and to ignore injuries that would be incapacitating. Classes like the Sorcerer and Paladin control their magic through sheer determination, and thus their abilities scale depending on their Willpower.

Intellect: Intellect represents memory, reason, and general cognitive capability. It contributes to knowledge-based and investigatory skills, as well as determining how many skills a character can train in and the number of magic items they can use at one time. Wizards derive their magic from study, research, and clever workarounds, thus Intellect, and all classes can benefit from the skills and items that a higher Intellect allows them to use.

Intuition: Intuition is your character’s ability to sense and connect with the world around them. Perception and other sensory skills are based on it, and it contributes to your initiative and defenses. Primal classes like the Druid and Warden draw power from the spirits of nature around them, and greater Intuition allows them to better connect with these.

Social: Your Social attribute is a catch-all for a variety of social interactions. Any time your character is persuading or

deceiving another character, acting, performing, negotiating, navigating a party, or similar, they use their Social attribute to help say the right things to the right people at the right time. Clerics are given their divine power by a god, and their faithfulness to that god's teachings helps to determine the amount and the strength of the magic they receive, thus they cast with Social.

Assigning Attributes

At this point in the character creation process, your character will have a value of 0 in each of these attributes. You have a total of 27 points to distribute across them, though higher values take more points to attain, according to the following table:

Score	1	2	3	4	5	6
Cost	1	2	4	6	9	12

Thus, if Bobbin the Fighter wants to have 6 Strength, they must spend 12 points, leaving them with 15 remaining points to distribute across the remaining 6 attributes.

Skills

Skills

Stamina

Stamina is a core resource shared by all classes. It represents your character's ability to continue to adventure without rest. Most healing requires you to spend a point of stamina, as does Combining Actions. You only fully replenish your stamina after an uninterrupted long rest.